IPCC ASSESSMENT REPORTS

INSTITUTIONAL IDENTITY MAP → ASSESSMENT-PRODUCTION RAIL → THREE-WORKING-GROUP MATRIX → TFI FIREWALL → REPORT-FAMILY HIERARCHY → CYCLE STATUS GATE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00 →

STAGE 00 INSTITUTIONAL IDENTITY MAP

INSTITUTIONAL IDENTITY MAP · SCIENTIFIC ASSESSMENT BY AN INTERGOVERNMENTAL BODY · TREATY FRAMEWORK AND NEGOTIATION PROCESS · COP OR CMA · PARTY DECISION-MAKING FORUM · NATIONAL GOVERNMENT · POLICY AND IMPLEMENTATION · ASSESSMENT EVIDENCE IS NOT A NEGOTIATED OBLIGATION

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
IPCC → scientific assessment by an intergovernmental body	COP OR CMA → party decision-making forum	RULE → assessment evidence is not a negotiated obligation
UNFCCC → treaty framework and negotiation process	NATIONAL GOVERNMENT → policy and implementation	IPCC → scientific assessment by an intergovernmental body

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER
- IPCC → scientific assessment by an intergovernmental body
- UNFCCC → treaty framework and negotiation process

DECISIVE DISTINCTION
- COP OR CMA → party decision-making forum
- NATIONAL GOVERNMENT → policy and implementation

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
- RULE → assessment evidence is not a negotiated obligation
- IPCC → scientific assessment by an intergovernmental body

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → assessment evidence is not a negotiated obligation.

01 →

STAGE 01 ASSESSMENT-PRODUCTION RAIL

ASSESSMENT-PRODUCTION RAIL · PUBLISHED LITERATURE · ASSESSED EVIDENCE BASE · EVALUATE FINDINGS, AGREEMENT AND GAPS · EXPERT AND GOVERNMENT REVIEW · COMMENTS ADDRESSED AND TRACEABILITY STRENGTHENED · PLENARY STATUS · PRODUCT-SPECIFIC APPROVAL OR ACCEPTANCE

PUBLISHED LITERATURE → assessed evidence base → AUTHORS → evaluate findings, agreement and gaps → DRAFTS → expert and government review → REVISION → comments addressed and traceability strengthened → PLENARY STATUS → product-specific approval or acceptance

SYSTEM INPUT / STARTING CONDITION
- PUBLISHED LITERATURE → assessed evidence base
- AUTHORS → evaluate findings, agreement and gaps

ECOLOGICAL PROCESS / TRANSFER
- DRAFTS → expert and government review
- REVISION → comments addressed and traceability strengthened

OUTCOME / FEEDBACK / LIMIT
- PLENARY STATUS → product-specific approval or acceptance
- PUBLISHED LITERATURE → assessed evidence base

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REVISION → comments addressed and traceability strengthened; PLENARY STATUS → product-specific approval or acceptance.

02 →

STAGE 02 THREE-WORKING-GROUP MATRIX

THREE-WORKING-GROUP MATRIX · WG I · PHYSICAL SCIENCE, OBSERVATIONS, DRIVERS AND PROJECTIONS · WG II · IMPACTS, ADAPTATION AND VULNERABILITY · WG III · MITIGATION PATHWAYS AND ENABLING CONDITIONS · NO NEGOTIATION

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
WG I → physical science, observations, drivers and projections	WG III → mitigation pathways and enabling conditions	INTEGRATION → Synthesis Report joins assessment findings
WG II → impacts, adaptation and vulnerability	NO NEGOTIATION → none sets a Party's NDC	WG I → physical science, observations, drivers and projections

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER
- WG I → physical science, observations, drivers and projections
- WG II → impacts, adaptation and vulnerability

DECISIVE DISTINCTION
- WG III → mitigation pathways and enabling conditions
- NO NEGOTIATION → none sets a Party's NDC

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
- INTEGRATION → Synthesis Report joins assessment findings
- WG I → physical science, observations, drivers and projections

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NO NEGOTIATION → none sets a Party's NDC.

03 →

STAGE 03 TFI FIREWALL

TFI FIREWALL · IPCC BODY · TASK FORCE ON NATIONAL GREENHOUSE GAS INVENTORIES · METHODOLOGY DEVELOPMENT AND REFINEMENT · INVENTORY GUIDANCE AND METHODOLOGY REPORTS · NOT WG IV · NO FOURTH THEMATIC ASSESSMENT MANDATE · SUPPORTS COMPARABLE NATIONAL REPORTING METHODS

IPCC BODY → Task Force on National Greenhouse Gas Inventories

FUNCTION → methodology development and refinement → OUTPUT → inventory guidance and methodology reports → NOT WG IV → no fourth thematic assessment mandate

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- IPCC BODY → Task Force on National Greenhouse Gas Inventories
- FUNCTION → methodology development and refinement

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- OUTPUT → inventory guidance and methodology reports
- NOT WG IV → no fourth thematic assessment mandate

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- LINK → supports comparable national reporting methods
- IPCC BODY → Task Force on National Greenhouse Gas Inventories

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NOT WG IV → no fourth thematic assessment mandate.

04 →

STAGE 04 REPORT-FAMILY HIERARCHY

REPORT-FAMILY HIERARCHY · ASSESSMENT CYCLE · WORKING GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS · SYNTHESIS REPORT · INTEGRATION ACROSS THE CYCLE · SPECIAL REPORT · DEFINED URGENT THEME · METHODOLOGY REPORT

ASSESSMENT CYCLE → Working Group contributions

SYNTHESIS REPORT → integration across the cycle → SPECIAL REPORT → defined urgent theme → METHODOLOGY REPORT → measurement or inventory method

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- ASSESSMENT CYCLE → Working Group contributions
- SYNTHESIS REPORT → integration across the cycle

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- SPECIAL REPORT → defined urgent theme
- METHODOLOGY REPORT → measurement or inventory method

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- STATUS → title, outline and publication are different facts
- ASSESSMENT CYCLE → Working Group contributions

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATUS → title, outline and publication are different facts.

05 →

STAGE 05 CYCLE STATUS GATE

CYCLE STATUS GATE · SCOPING OR OUTLINE · INTENDED COVERAGE · DRAFT EVIDENCE ASSESSMENT · EXPERT AND GOVERNMENT COMMENTS · APPROVAL OR ACCEPTANCE · PRODUCT-SPECIFIC PLENARY ACT · CITABLE COMPLETED PRODUCT

SCOPING OR OUTLINE → intended coverage

AUTHORING → draft evidence assessment → REVIEW → expert and government comments → APPROVAL OR ACCEPTANCE → product-specific plenary act

SYSTEM INPUT / STARTING CONDITION
- SCOPING OR OUTLINE → intended coverage
- AUTHORING → draft evidence assessment

ECOLOGICAL PROCESS / TRANSFER
- REVIEW → expert and government comments
- APPROVAL OR ACCEPTANCE → product-specific plenary act

OUTCOME / FEEDBACK / LIMIT
- PUBLICATION → citable completed product
- SCOPING OR OUTLINE → intended coverage

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: APPROVAL OR ACCEPTANCE → product-specific plenary act; PUBLICATION → citable completed product.

06 →

STAGE 06 SPM GOVERNANCE LADDER

SPM GOVERNANCE LADDER · SCIENTIST AUTHORS · DEFEND ASSESSED BASIS · GOVERNMENT DELEGATIONS · CONSIDER WORDING LINE BY LINE · CONSISTENCY GATE · SUMMARY MUST REMAIN TIED TO REPORT · APPROVED SPM

SCIENTIST AUTHORS → defend assessed basis

GOVERNMENT DELEGATIONS → consider wording line by line → CONSISTENCY GATE → summary must remain tied to report → APPROVED SPM → policy-relevant high-level text

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- SCIENTIST AUTHORS → defend assessed basis
- GOVERNMENT DELEGATIONS → consider wording line by line

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- CONSISTENCY GATE → summary must remain tied to report
- APPROVED SPM → policy-relevant high-level text

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- LIMIT → not a treaty target or national law
- SCIENTIST AUTHORS → defend assessed basis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → not a treaty target or national law.

07 →

STAGE 07 CALIBRATED-LANGUAGE MATRIX

CALIBRATED-LANGUAGE MATRIX · EVIDENCE AND AGREEMENT SUPPORTING A FINDING · ASSESSED PROBABILITY OF A DEFINED OUTCOME · GLOBAL, REGIONAL AND LOCAL CLAIMS DIFFER · TERM STAYS WITH ITS EXACT SENTENCE · NO BORROWING · ONE CALIBRATED TERM CANNOT VALIDATE ANOTHER CLAIM

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
CONFIDENCE → evidence and agreement supporting a finding	SCALE → global, regional and local claims differ	NO BORROWING → one calibrated term cannot validate another claim
LIKELIHOOD → assessed probability of a defined outcome	ATTACHMENT → term stays with its exact sentence	CONFIDENCE → evidence and agreement supporting a finding

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER
- CONFIDENCE → evidence and agreement supporting a finding
- LIKELIHOOD → assessed probability of a defined outcome

DECISIVE DISTINCTION
- SCALE → global, regional and local claims differ
- ATTACHMENT → term stays with its exact sentence

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
- NO BORROWING → one calibrated term cannot validate another claim
- CONFIDENCE → evidence and agreement supporting a finding

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NO BORROWING → one calibrated term cannot validate another claim.

08 →

STAGE 08 SCENARIO FIREWALL

SCENARIO FIREWALL · SOCIOECONOMIC OR EMISSIONS PATHWAY · MODEL RESPONSE · CONDITIONAL CLIMATE PROJECTION · RISK ASSESSMENT · IMPACTS UNDER THE STATED PATHWAY · POLICY OPTION · SEPARATELY EVALUATED

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- ASSUMPTIONS → socioeconomic or emissions pathway
- MODEL RESPONSE → conditional climate projection

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- RISK ASSESSMENT → impacts under the stated pathway
- POLICY OPTION → separately evaluated

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- NOT FORECAST → no unconditional prediction
- ASSUMPTIONS → socioeconomic or emissions pathway

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RISK ASSESSMENT → impacts under the stated pathway.

09 →

STAGE 09 ASSESSMENT-LAG TIMELINE

ASSESSMENT-LAG TIMELINE · LITERATURE CUT-OFF · EVIDENCE ELIGIBLE FOR ASSESSMENT · DRAFT AND REVIEW · SYNTHESIS TAKES TIME · COMPLETED ASSESSMENT BASELINE · NEW STUDIES · MAY POST-DATE THE CUT-OFF

LITERATURE CUT-OFF → evidence eligible for assessment → DRAFT AND REVIEW → synthesis takes time → PUBLICATION → completed assessment baseline → NEW STUDIES → may post-date the cut-off → NEXT PRODUCT → later incorporation is not automatic

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- LITERATURE CUT-OFF → evidence eligible for assessment
- DRAFT AND REVIEW → synthesis takes time

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- PUBLICATION → completed assessment baseline
- NEW STUDIES → may post-date the cut-off

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- NEXT PRODUCT → later incorporation is not automatic
- LITERATURE CUT-OFF → evidence eligible for assessment

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NEXT PRODUCT → later incorporation is not automatic.

10 →

STAGE 10 AR6-AR7 STATUS BOARD

AR6-AR7 STATUS BOARD · COMPLETED ASSESSMENT CYCLE · CYCLE IN PROGRESS IN OFFICIAL MATERIAL CHECKED · PLANNED COVERAGE, NOT EVIDENCE · INTENDED TIMING, NOT PUBLICATION · EXAM RULE · CITE REPORT, YEAR, GROUP AND STATUS EXACTLY

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
AR6 → completed assessment cycle	OUTLINE → planned coverage, not evidence	EXAM RULE → cite report, year, group and status exactly
AR7 → cycle in progress in official material checked	SCHEDULE → intended timing, not publication	AR6 → completed assessment cycle

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER
- AR6 → completed assessment cycle
- AR7 → cycle in progress in official material checked

DECISIVE DISTINCTION
- OUTLINE → planned coverage, not evidence
- SCHEDULE → intended timing, not publication

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
- EXAM RULE → cite report, year, group and status exactly
- AR6 → completed assessment cycle

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXAM RULE → cite report, year, group and status exactly.

11 →

STAGE 11 IPCC ANSWER SPINE

IPCC ANSWER SPINE · ASSESSMENT BODY, ORIGIN AND NON-RESEARCH MANDATE · WG I, WG II, WG III, TFI AND SYNTHESIS · AUTHORS, REVIEW, SPM AND PRODUCT STATUS · CONFIDENCE, LIKELIHOOD, SCENARIO AND CUT-OFF · INFORMS UNFCCC BUT DOES NOT NEGOTIATE POLICY

DEFINE → assessment body, origin and non-research mandate → ORGANISE → WG I, WG II, WG III, TFI and Synthesis → TRACE → authors, review, SPM and product status → QUALIFY → confidence, likelihood, scenario and cut-off → CONNECT → informs UNFCCC but does not negotiate policy

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- DEFINE → assessment body, origin and non-research mandate
- ORGANISE → WG I, WG II, WG III, TFI and Synthesis

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- TRACE → authors, review, SPM and product status
- QUALIFY → confidence, likelihood, scenario and cut-off

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- CONNECT → informs UNFCCC but does not negotiate policy
- DEFINE → assessment body, origin and non-research mandate

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ORGANISE → WG I, WG II, WG III, TFI and Synthesis.

E →

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE IPCC'S MANDATE IS EXPLICITLY TO BE "POLICY-RELEVANT BUT · ANALYTICAL SIGNIFICANCE · THIS DESIGN CHOICE IS PRECISELY WHAT ALLOWS THE IPCC'S · IPCC ASSESSMENT CYCLES ARE NECESSARILY BACKWARD-LOOKING TO SOME DEGREE · THE "CONSERVATIVE BY DESIGN" CRITIQUE (SECTION 1) IS A · REGIONAL-SCALE PROJECTIONS (E.G., SPECIFIC SOUTH ASIAN MONSOON-SHIFT MAGNITUDE) CARRY · IPCC USES A CALIBRATED DUAL-LANGUAGE SYSTEM

OPTIONAL ECOLOGICAL PROCESS DEPTH
- The IPCC's mandate is explicitly to be "policy-relevant but not policy-prescriptive" —
- CAUTION: Analytical significance: this design choice is precisely what allows the IPCC's
- CAUTION: IPCC assessment cycles are necessarily backward-looking to some degree, since they
- CAUTION: The "conservative by design" critique (Section 1) is a documented viewpoint among some

SCALE, PARAMETER OR STATUS LIMIT
- CAUTION: Regional-scale projections (e.g., specific South Asian monsoon-shift magnitude) carry
- IPCC uses a calibrated dual-language system: qualitative confidence levels (evidence/
- The Special Report on Global Warming of 1.5°C (2018) directly informed the Paris
- The IPCC's mandate is explicitly "policy-relevant but not policy-prescriptive."

COMPARATIVE RESTORATION NUANCE
- IPCC assessments are inherently time-bound to their literature cut-off date, creating an
- NOT: "High confidence" and "likely" are interchangeable IPCC terms meaning the same thing.
- NOT: The IPCC recommends specific national policies for governments to adopt. - Its mandate
- NOT: IPCC Special Reports are simply shorter versions of the regular assessment cycle.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels